

Five-Year Technology Equipment Replacement Plan

Ardent ISD | 2026-27 through 2030-31

Planning Principles

- Replace based on risk, lifecycle, supportability, and operational need - not age alone.
- Coordinate device and infrastructure replacement with district budget cycles.
- Maintain inventory fields that support forecasting: purchase date, model, warranty, location, condition, replacement year, and criticality.
- Revisit the plan annually as enrollment, pricing, support terms, and district priorities change.

Five-Year Forecast

Fiscal Year	Primary Replacement Groups	Estimated Cost	Leadership Notes
2026-27	3,860 student devices; 275 staff devices; 68 WAPs; 22 UPS batteries	\$1,842,000	Largest student-device cohort. Coordinate wireless refresh with AHS project.
2027-28	2,740 student devices; 310 staff devices; 96 WAPs; 14 switches	\$1,566,000	Review switching capacity and licensing before procurement.
2028-29	2,120 student devices; 290 staff devices; 121 WAPs; storage expansion	\$1,438,000	Revalidate storage need against cloud/service changes before purchase.
2029-30	2,660 student devices; 305 staff devices; 18 switches; 30 UPS batteries	\$1,612,000	Higher network infrastructure year; plan implementation windows early.
2030-31	2,480 student devices; 330 staff devices; 102 WAPs; server/virtualization host refresh	\$1,704,000	Reassess physical/virtual/cloud strategy before finalizing host replacement.

Replacement Priority Rules

Priority	Condition	Typical Leadership Response
Critical	Unsupported system, safety/continuity risk, repeated failure, or single point of failure	Address immediately or create a documented mitigation.
High	Within replacement window with rising support burden or meaningful performance impact	Fund in next annual cycle.
Planned	Within expected lifecycle and currently supportable	Schedule within the five-year plan.
Monitor	Still supportable but showing early risk indicators	Track condition, tickets, warranty, and vendor support status.

Budget Strategy

The forecast should be treated as a rolling plan, not a promise of exact prices. Each year, the CTO should:

1. update counts from verified inventory;
2. review warranty and support dates;
3. update enrollment and staffing assumptions;
4. identify grant, E-Rate, bond, or local funding opportunities where applicable;
5. review total lifecycle cost, including licenses, management, accessories, spares, implementation, and support.

Equity Check

Replacement decisions should examine whether campuses have materially different:

- device age;
- spare-pool levels;
- repair turnaround;
- wireless density;
- accessibility requirements;
- staff support capacity.

Reference Points

- [CoSN IT Management Resources](#) - K-12 technology operations and leadership resources.
- [USAC E-Rate Program](#) - Federal E-Rate program information for schools and libraries.
- [SETDA Infrastructure for the Future](#) - Guidance for future-ready broadband and infrastructure planning.
- [Future Ready Schools Frameworks](#) - Systems-oriented planning connecting infrastructure, learning, leadership, budget, and equity.

Leadership use: This document is designed to support district-level review, discussion, and decision-making. Technical validation, procurement review, legal review, or compliance review should be completed by the appropriate district specialists when applicable.